PARENT GUIDANCE · DESIGN SYSTEM

Motion

Design guidelines · Parent Guidance · Updated October 15, 2026

The prototype animates with `motion` (Framer Motion, `motion/react`). Principle: **safe, unhurried** motion, never bouncy, and always respecting reduced-motion.

4.1 Tokens

Durations and curves live in `tokens.css`:

Band	Duration	CSS variable	Tailwind class	Use
Micro	0.15s	`--pg-dur-micro`	`duration-(--pg-dur-micro)`	Press, color change, sort menus
Fast	0.22s	`--pg-dur-fast`	`duration-(--pg-dur-fast)`	Hover, icons, pop-ups
Base	0.35s	`--pg-dur-base`	`duration-(--pg-dur-base)`	Accordions, menus, modals, view changes
Reveal	0.55s	`--pg-dur-reveal`	`duration-(--pg-dur-reveal)`	Content entrance on scroll

Curve	Value	Use
`ease-pg-out`	`[0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94]`	Brand curve: entrances, reveals, pop-ups
`ease-pg-in-out`	`[0.65, 0, 0.35, 1]`	Open/close, accordions, tabs

In `motion` props, write the numbers (`transition={{ duration: 0.55, ease: [0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94] }}`). Stagger between cards in a grid: **0.06s**, for the first 6 items only.

4.2 Patterns

Reveal on scroll

Used gently and **only once**:

```
<motion.div
  initial={{ opacity: 0, y: 16 }}
  whileInView={{ opacity: 1, y: 0 }}
  viewport={{ once: true, margin: "-60px" }}
  transition={{ duration: 0.55, ease: [0.25, 0.46, 0.45, 0.94] }}
/>
```

- Vertical offset of **16–24px**. Horizontal offsets (`x`) only in heroes and image + text rows, 32–48px at most, and a page that uses them gets `overflow-x-clip` so it doesn't create horizontal scroll on mobile.
- Always `once: true` : content doesn't hide again when scrolling up.
- Grids: `delay: index * 0.06` , for the first 6 items only.

Interaction feedback

Element	Animation
Buttons (`<Button>`)	`whileTap={{ scale: 0.97 }}` + color with `transition-colors` . Hover changes color only
Clickable cards	Hover: `card-hover` shadow and `y: -2` . No scaling
Featured images	Hover: **1.02** maximum scale (or no animation)
Social icons	Hover: `y: -2` , no scaling
Accordion / FAQ	`auto` height + opacity, 0.35s; the `+` icon rotates 45°
Pop-ups and modals	Backdrop fades; panel `opacity 0 → 1` , `scale 0.97 → 1` , `y: -6 → 0` , 0.22s
Confirmations ("✓ Question Submitted")	`opacity 0 → 1` , `scale 0.9 → 1` , 0.35s, `ease-pg-out`

What to avoid

- Bouncy `type: "spring"` .
- `whileHover` scaling above 1.02.
- `whileHover` color changes in `motion` : use Tailwind `hover:` classes.
- Infinite or decorative animations. The only exception is the "live" dot (soft pulse), and only while that state is active.
- Entrance animations on the **Get Help** page: crisis content is visible from the very first moment (`initial={false}`).
- Animating the hero or the first visible block in a way that makes the page look empty on load.

4.3 Scrolling

- Every navigation opens the new page at the top (`<ScrollRestoration />` in the root layout); back/forward restores the position.
- "Back to top" buttons and page changes use `scrollBehavior()` from `src/lib/motion.ts`: `"smooth"`, or `"auto"` when the user asks for reduced motion.

4.4 Reduced-motion contract (mandatory)

Implemented. The app is wrapped in `MotionConfig`:

```
// src/app/App.tsx
<MotionConfig reducedMotion="user">{/* …app… */}</MotionConfig>
```

With `reducedMotion="user"`, `motion` turns off movement and scaling for anyone who has the system setting enabled, and keeps opacity changes. CSS transitions are turned off by the `@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce)` rule in `accessibility.css`.

Rule: **no content may stay hidden** (`opacity: 0`) if the animation doesn't run.